the ugly

Mugling

FROM THE CLAYS OF KHURJA

Seven weeks.
One real business.

Hand-painted ceramics brought from Khurja, Uttar Pradesh, and sold in Bengaluru — at stalls, online, and to companies buying in bulk.

THE NAME

Named after a duckling.

Everybody already knows how that story ends.

A mugling is a diminutive — duckling, nestling, mugling. A small thing newly out of the clay that somebody takes home and decides is theirs.

The first half of the name is the affectionate half. It is the way families here talk about the things they love most, and it was never a claim about what is in the box.

Everything that leaves the kiln in Khurja goes out plain. Somebody picks up a brush, and it stops being one of a batch.



One of the nineteen is, as it happens, a duck.

WEEK ONE

We chose the supplier before we chose the brand.

We needed three things: evidence someone would pay, a margin worth the trouble, and a supplier who would not become a single point of failure.

We tested three ideas against those questions. Ceramics was the one that survived all three.

Khurja has been firing pottery for two hundred years. We found a workshop there that still paints every piece by hand, and it quoted us in writing — price, minimum order, lead time.

It also handed us the problem we live with: ceramics break, and Khurja is 2,000 km away.



Every other early decision is a rewrite. The supplier decision is a reorder, and it costs you weeks.

THE PRODUCT

Somebody's hands made this.



Every one of these is painted in Khurja by hand, one at a time, by someone who has done it for a while. No two come out quite alike.

You can tell a person made it, and so can whoever you give it to. That is the whole argument, and nothing needs to be added to it.

WHAT IT IS

Glazed ceramic, hand-painted under glaze. Food safe, dishwasher safe. Made in Khurja, Uttar Pradesh.

THE RANGE

Nineteen designs.

Mugs, cups, bowls, plates and platters — shown at their true sizes relative to each other.



WHERE WE ARE TODAY

₹1,00,703 collected and proved.

25.2%

OF THE ₹4,00,000 TARGET

Proved means the money landed and we can show you the record. Promised orders are not revenue, and we do not count them.

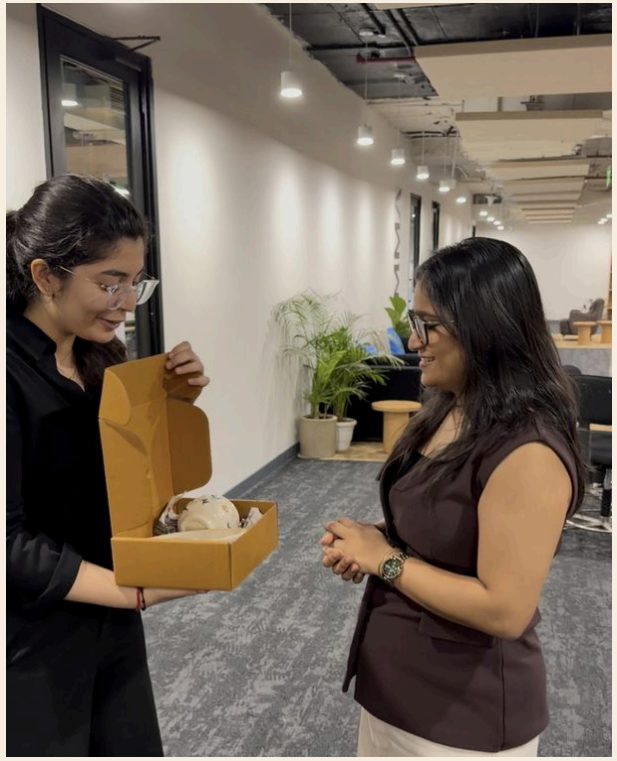
UNITS SOLD	290
AVERAGE ORDER	₹757 — people buy pairs, not singles
CASH ON HAND	₹52,005
MESA CAPITAL	₹30,000 outstanding, due 30 September
STILL TO SELL	₹2,99,297

ALREADY OUT THERE

Somebody takes it home.



The first ones went at a stall in a society courtyard, wrapped in a paper bag.



The rest arrive in a box, and get opened at somebody's desk.

TWO HUNDRED AND NINETY SO FAR

We have stood behind the table for every one of them. The face when the box opens is the whole reason this exists.

WHO WE ARE

The four of us.

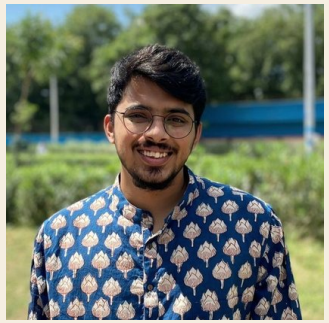
Four postgraduate students at Mesa School of Business. Between us we have worked in software, in marketing and in founders' offices. None of us in ceramics.

The titles below are where each of us starts, not where we stop. Every one of us has stood behind the stall table and asked a stranger for the sale.



Piyush Agrawal

PARTNERSHIPS



Joy Mukhopadhyay

SALES



Aaditaa Vasisht

PRODUCT & OPERATIONS



Harsha Vardan

GROWTH & B2B

THE FIVE GATES

Three cleared. Two left.

M1

Pitch, raise the first tranche, store live

CLEARED · WEEK 2

M2

Brand, packaging, e-commerce live

CLEARED · WEEK 4

M3

First marketing campaign

THIS WEEK · WEEK 5

M4

Multi-channel report

AHEAD · WEEK 6

M5

Mesa Flea and repayment

AHEAD · 6 SEPTEMBER

The last gate is two things at once. The Mesa Flea is the single biggest selling day of the challenge, and the week the capital goes back to Mesa.

HOW WE SELL IT

Three ways to buy the same mug.



One at a time

₹250 to ₹700 at a stall, on the website, or over WhatsApp. Most people leave with two.

As a set

The Pair at ₹390 — one mug, one bowl. The Table at ₹600 — a whole place setting.

By the fifty

Bulk buyers want a number and a price, not a rate card. Fifty mugs, or a hundred and fifty. The rate falls as it climbs.

WHAT HAPPENS NEXT

Four things left to do.

01

Sell where people already are

Flea markets and society pop-ups, every weekend from here. It is the highest conversion we get, because we can answer the objection out loud.

02

Open the line still at zero

B2B has not earned a rupee yet and it is the fastest-moving thing on the page. One corporate order can beat a week of retail.

03

Ride a calendar we did not make

Ganesh Chaturthi and Teachers' Day both fall inside the sprint. Gift urgency on a deadline somebody else set for us.

04

Overstock the Flea

The last Sunday is the biggest selling day of the whole challenge. Turning up short is the one mistake that cannot be fixed on the day.

WHERE TO FIND US

Come to the Flea.

One room, the whole cohort, and everything we have left on the table. Bring somebody who already owns too many mugs.










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FROM THE CLAYS OF KHURJA

Made by hand in Khurja.
Carried to Bengaluru.
Sold one at a time.